

SOC Analyst — Minimum Requirements to Apply

Complete everything marked **MUST HAVE** before sending first application | Target: ₹4–6.5 LPA

CERTIFICATIONS — Minimum to Apply

	Certification	Provider	Must Have / Nice to Have	Where to Get
☐	ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)	ISC2	MUST HAVE	isc2.org/certifications/cc — free exam
☐	Introduction to Cybersecurity	Cisco NetAcad	MUST HAVE	netacad.com — free
☐	Cybersecurity Essentials	Cisco NetAcad	MUST HAVE	netacad.com — free
☐	Junior Cybersecurity Analyst Path	Cisco NetAcad	MUST HAVE	netacad.com — free
☐	Fortinet NSE 1 + NSE 2	Fortinet	MUST HAVE	training.fortinet.com — free
☐	Google Cybersecurity Certificate	Google/Coursera	Strong to Have	Coursera financial aid — free
☐	IBM Security Analyst Fundamentals	IBM SkillsBuild	Strong to Have	skillsbuild.org — free
☐	Fortinet NSE 3	Fortinet	Nice to Have	training.fortinet.com — free
☐	Linux Essentials	Cisco NetAcad	Nice to Have	netacad.com — free

TRYHACKME ROOMS — Minimum to Apply

	Room Name	Free/Premium	Must Have / Nice to Have	Why It Matters for SOC
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☐	Pre-Security Path	FREE	MUST HAVE	Foundation for everything — networking, Linux, web basics
☐	SOC Fundamentals	FREE	MUST HAVE	You need to know your own job role before applying
☐	Intro to SIEM	FREE	MUST HAVE	SIEM is asked about in every SOC interview
☐	Splunk Basics	FREE	MUST HAVE	Splunk is the most used SIEM in Indian SOC teams
☐	Phishing Analysis Fundamentals	FREE	MUST HAVE	Most common SOC L1 task — phishing triage
☐	Windows Event Logs	FREE	MUST HAVE	Windows log analysis is daily SOC work
☐	MITRE ATT&CK	FREE	MUST HAVE	Every SOC interview asks about ATT&CK framework
☐	Cyber Kill Chain	FREE	MUST HAVE	Attack lifecycle — core SOC knowledge
☐	Wireshark Basics	FREE	Strong to Have	Network traffic analysis for SOC investigations
☐	Incident Response Fundamentals	FREE	Strong to Have	IR lifecycle — PICERL framework knowledge
☐	Defensive Security Intro	FREE	Strong to Have	Blue team mindset — good for interviews
☐	Pyramid of Pain	FREE	Nice to Have	IOC types — advanced SOC knowledge

☐	Cyber Threat Intelligence	FREE	Nice to Have	CTI concepts — differentiator in interviews
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5 GOATED PROJECTS — Pick 2 to Build Before Applying

	Project Name	What You Build	Tools / Stack	Why Recruiters Love It
☐	SIEM Home Lab with Splunk	Set up a free Splunk instance, ingest Windows/Linux logs from a VM, create 5 detection rules, build a dashboard showing alerts	Splunk Free (500MB/day) , VirtualBox , Windows Server Trial , Kali Linux	<i>Shows you've actually used the #1 SOC tool. Most freshers only read about it — you've built with it. Instant credibility.</i>
☐	Phishing Email Analyser Tool	Build a Python tool that takes an email file (.eml), extracts headers, checks links against VirusTotal API, flags suspicious indicators, outputs a report	Python , VirusTotal API (free) , MXTtoolbox , email libraries	<i>Phishing triage is 40% of SOC L1 work. Showing you've automated it proves you understand the task deeply.</i>
☐	Incident Response Playbook + Simulation	Document a complete IR playbook for 3 scenarios (phishing, ransomware, data breach). Create a mock incident timeline and write the full response report	Markdown , GitHub , draw.io (free) , NIST IR framework	<i>IR documentation is a core SOC skill. A real written playbook on GitHub is something almost no fresher has.</i>
☐	Network Traffic Analyser	Capture network traffic using Wireshark/TShark, write a Python script to parse pcap files, flag suspicious connections, generate a findings report	Wireshark , TShark , Python (scapy/dpkt) , Pandas , Matplotlib	<i>Network analysis is daily SOC work. A working tool that automates pcap analysis is very impressive at fresher level.</i>
☐	Threat Intel Dashboard	Build a Streamlit dashboard that pulls IOCs from free threat feeds, displays threat actor activity, lets you search IPs/domains against VirusTotal	Python , Streamlit , VirusTotal API , AlienVault OTX API (free)	<i>CTI dashboards are used in every mature SOC. Building one from scratch proves you understand threat intelligence operationally.</i>